

GENERAL ENGLISH (IDIOMS & PHRASES SERIES)

PRACTICE SHEET MEDIUM LEVEL (SET 1) / INTERMEDIATE IDIOMS & MEANINGS (30 QUESTIONS)

1. What is the meaning of the idiom: "A dime a dozen"

- (A) Very common and of little value
- (B) Extremely expensive items
- (C) Exactly twelve coins
- (D) Rare collector pieces

2. What is the meaning of the idiom: "A leopard cannot change its spots"

- (A) People cannot change their basic character or nature
- (B) Wild animals adapt to new environments easily
- (C) Patterns on clothing fade over time
- (D) Physical appearances alter as we age

3. What is the meaning of the idiom: "A penny for your thoughts"

- (A) Asking what someone is thinking about
- (B) Offering a small monetary reward
- (C) Buying advice from a stranger
- (D) Valuing opinions very cheaply

4. What is the meaning of the idiom: "A slip of the tongue"

- (A) An unintentional mistake in speaking
- (B) A physical injury to the mouth
- (C) Speaking multiple languages fluently
- (D) A deliberate lie told to deceive

5. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Actions speak louder than words"

- (A) What you do reveals more than what you say
- (B) Shouting makes conversations clearer
- (C) Verbal promises are always binding
- (D) Silence is golden in arguments

6. What is the meaning of the idiom: "At the drop of a hat"

- (A) Instantly without any hesitation
- (B) Dropping clothing items accidentally
- (C) Waiting patiently for a signal
- (D) Taking off accessories outdoors

7. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Ball is in your court"

- (A) It is your responsibility to make the next move
- (B) You are currently playing sports
- (C) Someone else holds authority over you
- (D) The game has been suspended

8. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Barking up the wrong tree"

- (A) Pursuing a mistaken course of action
- (B) Training pets in the forest
- (C) Shouting at innocent bystanders
- (D) Climbing the wrong ladder at work

9. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Be glad to see the back of"

- (A) Be happy when an annoying person or thing leaves
- (B) Turn around quickly to face someone
- (C) Support a colleague from behind
- (D) Say goodbye politely at a door

10. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Beat around the bush"

- (A) Avoid speaking directly about a sensitive topic
- (B) Clean up garden foliage thoroughly
- (C) Search for hidden objects outdoors
- (D) Walk around a park perimeter

11. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Bite off more than you can chew"

- (A) Take on commitments beyond your capability
- (B) Eat food much too quickly
- (C) Order excessive portions at a restaurant
- (D) Share food generously with friends

12. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Blessing in disguise"

- (A) A misfortune that eventually turns out for the best
- (B) A hidden danger behind good news
- (C) A disguised person offering help
- (D) An unexpected financial bonus

13. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Burn bridges"

- (A) Destroy relationships or opportunities permanently
- (B) Demolish old architectural structures
- (C) Escape safely from a dangerous zone
- (D) Cut off travel routes during war

14. What is the meaning of the idiom: "By the skin of your teeth"

- (A) Barely succeeding or escaping a difficult situation
- (B) Experiencing intense dental pain
- (C) Smiling broadly despite sadness
- (D) Biting down hard on food

15. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Cast iron guarantee"

- (A) An absolute and unbreakable promise or assurance
- (B) A metal manufacturing warranty
- (C) A heavy cookware safety test
- (D) A temporary verbal agreement

16. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Catch someone red-handed"

- (A) Discover someone in the act of doing wrong
- (B) Injure someone's hands accidentally
- (C) Paint walls with crimson pigment
- (D) Greet a friend with bloody fingers

17. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Change of heart"

- (A) A modification in attitude or opinion
- (B) A surgical cardiac procedure
- (C) Falling in love with someone new
- (D) Experiencing sudden chest pains

18. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Chase rainbows"

- (A) Pursue illusory, impossible, or impractical goals
- (B) Follow weather storms outdoors
- (C) Paint colorful landscape artwork
- (D) Look for treasure after rainstorms

19. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Chip on your shoulder"

- (A) Being resentful or harboring a grievance
- (B) Balancing heavy items on your back
- (C) Having a wood splinter injury
- (D) Wearing decorative shoulder pads

20. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Come hell or high water"

- (A) No matter what difficulties or obstacles arise
- (B) Surviving natural flood disasters
- (C) Traveling through severe thunderstorms
- (D) Escaping underground volcanic heat

21. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Cut to the chase"

- (A) Get straight to the point without unnecessary details (B) Stop running after fleeing suspects
(C) Edit action sequences in movies (D) Shorten a long story deliberately

22. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Dark horse"

- (A) An unexpected winner or competitor (B) A black stallion in a race
(C) A mysterious criminal suspect (D) An uncooperative team member

23. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Devil's advocate"

- (A) Someone who argues against a position for the sake of debate (B) A defense lawyer defending criminals
(C) An evil person influencing decisions (D) A critic who hates everything

24. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Don't count your chickens before they hatch"

- (A) Do not assume success until it actually happens (B) Farmers must monitor poultry farms closely
(C) Count eggs accurately before cooking (D) Avoid breeding farm animals early

25. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Down to earth"

- (A) Sensible, realistic, and humble (B) Falling heavily onto the ground
(C) Poor and financially destitute (D) Deeply interested in gardening

26. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Drastic times call for drastic measures"

- (A) Severe problems require extreme actions to fix them (B) Emergency services must work faster
(C) Difficult schedules need careful planning (D) Hard work always leads to success

27. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Drunk on power"

- (A) Intoxicated or corrupted by authority and control (B) Consuming beverages during work hours
(C) Losing consciousness from exhaustion (D) Acting foolishly after drinking wine

28. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Easy come, easy go"

- (A) Money or possessions acquired easily are lost easily (B) Travel arrangements should be flexible
(C) Leaving places quickly is convenient (D) Friendship comes and goes naturally

29. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Elephant in the room"

- (A) An obvious problem that everyone avoids discussing (B) A large animal trapped inside a building
(C) A clumsy person causing trouble (D) A decorated statue in a living room

30. What is the meaning of the idiom: "Every cloud has a silver lining"

- (A) Every difficult situation has some hopeful aspect (B) Storm clouds always bring heavy rain
(C) Silver jewelry shines in sunlight (D) Weather patterns change rapidly

ANSWER KEY (Q1 - Q30)

Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans	Q.No	Ans
1	(A)	6	(A)	11	(A)	16	(A)	21	(A)	26	(A)
2	(A)	7	(A)	12	(A)	17	(A)	22	(A)	27	(A)
3	(A)	8	(A)	13	(A)	18	(A)	23	(A)	28	(A)
4	(A)	9	(A)	14	(A)	19	(A)	24	(A)	29	(A)
5	(A)	10	(A)	15	(A)	20	(A)	25	(A)	30	(A)